

factories. Choose a country because you like its people, climate, and way of life rather than its efficiency in getting a job done.

PRACTICAL MATTERS IN LIVING ABROAD

The rules are:

Try living abroad for three to six months

Keep calm; you can always return to the United States

Here's some practical advice to make sure you get started right.

VISAS

With an American passport you're entitled to live and work in the world's richest country. In the United States you enjoy the advantages of having freely elected statesmen, a strong military, a system of justice, and teenagers with glue in their hair. But the United States requires that all foreigners visiting the United States have visas. Most foreign countries outside of Western Europe reciprocate by requiring visas of visitors from the United States. Unfortunately, that means that with a passport U.S. you have to put up with the hassle of getting a visa for almost every country you visit.

A visa is a stamp placed by officials of a foreign country in your U.S. passport. A tourist card is similar to a visa but it's a separate piece of paper rather than a stamp in your passport. To get a country-by-country list of visa and tourist-card requirements, write the U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20401. Ask them to send you a free copy of the U.S. State Department's Bureau of Consular Affairs pamphlet *Visa Requirements of Foreign Governments*. Visa requirements change, but the State Department keeps the pamphlet fairly current.